

11th EFSPI Regulatory Statistics Workshop

19 – 20 August 2026

Basel Switzerland

Day 0: 18th August 2026, 19:00-22:00

19:00 – 22:00 **Pre-Conference Regulatory Dinner**

All regulators and HTA assessors are cordially invited to this (self-paid) event, organized by Benjamin Hofner (PEI, DE) and Heidi Mestl (SAWP member, NoMA, NO).
For more information and registration please visit <https://forms.gle/ihANxp8V3gUctCMu6>

Day 1: 19th August 2026, 08:30-17:30 (+1:30h get-together)

Time	Presentation
08:40 – 09:00 (5 + 15 min)	Housekeeping + Opening Remarks Anna Wiksten (EFSPI President, BMS, CH)
09:00 – 10:00 (60 min)	Short Topics ‘reversed’. Regulators Question, Industry Answers: An Interactive Panel Session A committee-selected set of pre-submitted questions is briefly introduced by regulators and then explored in a moderated panel discussion, where industry experts share their experience-based perspectives and practical insights in response. Note: Regulators are invited to submit a problem or question by 19 June 2026 . The Scientific Committee will review all submissions and select up to three topics. If selected, a regulator will be asked to introduce the topic in-person using <i>no more than three slides</i> in a <i>up to five-minute presentation</i> . A panel of industry experts will then discuss the question and share their insights. Proposals should be sent to Vivian Lanius, Vivian.lanius@ucb.com <i>Chairs:</i> Lukas Aguirre Dávila (SAWP member, PEI, DE), Julie Jones (Novartis, CH) <i>Panelists:</i> Cordula Zeller (Boehringer Ingelheim, DE), Evgeny Degtyarev (Novartis, CH), Marc Vandemeulebroecke (Bayer, CH), NN (affiliation, country code), NN (affiliation, country code), ... Topic 1: NN (affiliation, country code): Title Topic 2: NN (affiliation, country code): Title Topic 3: NN (affiliation, country code): Title
10:00 – 10:30 (30 min)	Coffee break

Day 1: 19th August 2026, 08:30-17:30 (+1:30h get-together) <continued>

Time	Presentation
10:30 – 12:30 (120 min)	Short Topics. Engaging Regulators: Industry Questions and Regulatory Insight A committee-selected set of pre-submitted industry questions is briefly introduced and then discussed by a panel of regulators, who share interpretations based on existing guidance and current regulatory thinking. Note: Please submit a problem or question by 19 June 2026. The Scientific Committee will review all submissions and select up to six topics. If selected, you will be asked to introduce your topic in-person using <i>no more than three slides</i> in a <i>up to five-minute presentation</i>. A panel of highly esteemed regulators will then discuss the question and share their insights with you and the audience. Proposals should be sent to Vivian Lanius, Vivian.lanius@ucb.com. <i>Chairs:</i> Heidi Mestl (SAWP member, NoMA, NO), Patrick Schlömer (Bayer, DE) <i>Panelists:</i> (*MWP member, #SAWP member) Juan José Abellán Andrés (EMA, NL), Elina Asikanius^{#*} (fimea, FI), Lukas Aguirre Dávila[#], Benjamin Hofner (PEI, DE), Andreas Brandt, Armin Schöler (BfArM, DE), Khadija Rerhou Rantell (MHRA, UK), Rafael Sauter (Swissmedic, CH) [if relevant, HTA experts: Jan-Lucca Bilek (G-BA, DE), Seamus Kent (ESHPM, NL)] Topic 1: NN (affiliation, country code): Title Topic 2: NN (affiliation, country code): Title ... Topic 5: NN (affiliation, country code): Title Topic 6: NN (affiliation, country code): Title
12:30 – 14:00 (90 min)	Lunch break and poster session: ESIGs and EFSPi Working Groups
14:00 – 15:30 (90 min)	Global Regulatory Strategic Priorities: Key Updates and Discussion with Health Authorities This session provides concise updates on current regulatory strategic priorities and key developments from global health authorities, including EMA, FDA, and MHRA/Swissmedic, with a focus on topics most relevant to industry. The updates are followed by an interactive discussion, offering the audience an opportunity to engage directly with presenters through questions and dialogue. <i>Chairs:</i> Andreas Brandt (BfArM, DE), Jenny Devenport (... , CH) Talk 1: Greg Levin (FDA, US, virtual): Titel of the presentation Talk 2: Elina Asikanius (SAWP & MWP member, fimea, FI): CTR and NPL? Why do these acronyms matter and why should a statistician be aware of European legislation? Talk 3: Jasvinder Singh (MHRA, UK) Titel of the presentation Q&A and moderated discussion with the audience, the speakers, and the panelist: Benjamin Hofner (PEI, DE).

15:30 – 16:00
(30 min) Coffee break

16:00 – 17:30 **Draft EMA Guideline on Non-Inferiority and Equivalence: Key Updates and Stakeholder Perspectives**
(90 min)

This session will summarize the key thinking behind the EMA draft guideline on non-inferiority and equivalence comparisons in clinical trials and the most important changes introduced. It will then examine and discuss selected stakeholder comments submitted during the public consultation, highlighting areas of consensus, concern, and potential impact on future practice.

Chairs: Anouk Neven (EMA, LU), Helle Lynggaard (Novo Nordisk, DK)

Talk 1: Susanne Urach (AGES, AT):
Key changes in the draft guideline with potential impact on future practice and received public comments

Talk 2: Tobias Mütze (Novartis, CH):
Opportunities and challenges in the draft EMA non-inferiority guideline: a stakeholder perspective

Q&A and discussion with the audience, the speakers and the panelists:
Florian Lasch (EMA, NL) and NN (affiliation, country code)

17:30 – 19:00 **Apéro & Informal Networking** – Enjoy light refreshments and drinks in a relaxed setting, and take the opportunity to continue conversations and connect with fellow participants.

Day 2: 20th August 2026, 09:00-17:30

Time	Presentation
09:00 – 10:30 (90 min)	Development of patient relevant and sensitive endpoints – opportunities for statisticians This session will address recent methodological developments in clinical endpoint selection and validation, with a focus on rare diseases and pediatric populations. Emphasis will be placed on the early involvement of statisticians in endpoint strategy, highlighting their role in disease-specific, patient-relevant, and sensitive outcome measure development, as well as the value of regulatory qualification pathways and qualification opinions to support robust evidence generation in areas of high unmet need. <i>Chairs:</i> Elina Asikanius (SAWP & MWP member, fimea, FI), Claudia Dallinger (Boehringer Ingelheim, DE) Talk 1: Tom Willgoss (Roche Products Limited, UK): Titel of the presentation How to identify relevant disease domains in a heterogeneous, multi-domain syndrome? Measuring what matters: case study from Angelmans Syndrome Talk 2: Laurent Servais (Professor of Paediatric Neuromuscular Diseases, University of Oxford, UK): Titel of the presentation Duchenne example: successful qualification replacing an old “standard” endpoint (6MWT) by a digital endpoint (stride velocity) Talk 3: Taco B.M. Monster (Medicines Evaluation Board, NL): Titel of the presentation Regulatory view on Qualification of novel endpoints Q&A and moderated discussion with the audience, the speakers and the panelist: Jan Lucca Bilek (G-BA, DE)
10:30 – 11:00 (30 min)	Coffee break
11:00 – 12:30 (90 min)	From first wave to future practice: learning from early Joint Clinical Assessments procedures During the summer, publication of the first European Joint Clinical Assessment (JCA) reports is expected. As the JCA process is new, it comes with methodological and procedural challenges for all stakeholders involved (particularly in the context of rare diseases). This session will serve to share experiences from the first JCAs including core methodological challenges, PICO selection, the appraisal of indirect treatment comparisons, and characterisation of uncertainty. Attendees will gain insights into how these issues are being interpreted within the evolving EU HTA framework from different angles. <i>Chairs:</i> Seamus Kent (ESHPM, NL), Katrin Kupas (Merck KgaA, CH) Talk 1: Antje Behring (Leonardo Symphony, DE): From PICO to Assessment Report: How HTA Bodies Navigate Uncertainty, Evidence Gaps and Diverging Perspectives Talk 2: Lars Beckmann (IQWiG, DE): A HTA representative involved in the EU JCA would give their views on the experiences and lessons learned from early JCAs with a focus on the implementation of the methodological guidance. Likely with a focus on addressing multiple PICOs and evidence synthesis Talk 3: Thomas Ecker (Ecker + Ecker & Accessus Health, DE): An industry representative from a company who has completed a JCA procedure to give their view on experiences and lessons learned Talk 4: Potentially an industry representative(?) (affiliation, country code): on experiences and lessons learned when completed a JCA procedure Q&A and moderated discussion with the audience and the speakers
12:30 – 14:00 (90 min)	Lunch break

Day 2: 20th August 2026, 09:00-17:30 <continued>

Time	Presentation
14:00 – 15:30 (90 min)	Aligned at Baseline? Closing the Gaps on Baseline Covariate Adjustment Adjusting for prognostic baseline covariates is a powerful tool for improving statistical efficiency in treatment effect estimation. But are industry and regulators fully aligned on its application? This session aims to close the gaps in current practice by: • Facilitating a candid dialogue between industry experts and regulators. • Clarifying current expectations and addressing perceived inconsistencies. • Fostering a shared, unified understanding of appropriate covariate adjustment strategies. <i>Chairs:</i> Benjamin Hofner (PEI, DE), Vivian Lanius (... , DE) Talk 1: Dominic Magirr (Novartis, CH): Titel of the presentation Educational talk covering unconditional vs. conditional treatment effects, Clarification of how this topic is different from assessing heterogeneity of treatment effects in subgroups, Difference between stratification and covariate adjustment, “Routine use of regression models to adjust” – what purpose do these models serve? Talk 2: Robin Ristl (Medical University of Vienna, AT): Titel of the presentation Regulatory insights / view / questions Q&A and moderated discussion with the audience, the speakers and the panelist: Seamus Kent (ESHPM, NL)
15:30 – 16:00 (30 min)	Coffee break
16:00 – 17:30 (90 min)	Synthetic Data in Biostatistics: Definitions, Regulatory Implications, and Practical Applications This session examines what is meant by <i>synthetic data</i> in the context of drug development, including key definitions, methodological approaches, and intended use cases. It further discusses the scientific, regulatory, and practical consequences of using synthetic data, highlighting opportunities, limitations, and implications for decision-making across development programs. <i>Chairs:</i> Khadija Rantell (MHRA, UK), Pierre Mancini (Sanofi, FR) Talk 1: NN (affiliation, country code): Titel of the presentation Introduction to Synthetic Data Fundamentals Suggested Duration Talk 2: NN (affiliation, country code): Titel of the presentation Buzz word or true innovation? What’s new about synthetic data ? or What's New About Synthetic Data? Beyond the hype in regulatory statistics Talk 3: Federico Mattiello (Roche, CH) and NN (MHRA, UK): Titel of the presentation Joint case-studies from MHRA & Industry and Validation Frameworks Q&A and moderated discussion with the audience, the speakers and the panelist: NN (affiliation, country code)
17:30 – 17:40	Closure Vivian Lanius (... , Organizing and Scientific Committee, DE)

Poster session of ESIGs and EFSPI Working Groups on Day 1 (19th August 2026, 12:30 – 14:00)

ESIG/EFSPI Working Group	Title	Presenter(s) on behalf of the respective ESIG/EFSPI WG
Regulatory SIG	EFSPI/PSI Regulatory European Special Interest Group (ESIG)	Fredrik Öhrn, Christoph Gerlinger
Multi-Component Endpoints SIG	EFSPI/PSI Multi-Component Endpoints SIG	Patrick Schlömer, Alex Ocampo, NN(?)
Launch and Lifecycle SIG	...	Jenny Devenport, ...
BBS Next Gen Committee	...	Muriel Buri, Nikki Rommers, ...
HTA SIG	...	...
Randomization SIG	Randomization Working Group – Bridging statistical innovation and clinical trial practice	Diane Uschner